

New Generation English B· Diagnostic Test

A2 (Elementary Strong) B· Full Test

READING

My grandfather's old box

Last weekend I helped my parents tidy the attic. While we were sorting old boxes, I found a small wooden box that had belonged to my grandfather. He died when I was seven, so I did not remember him very well. The box was dusty and the lock was broken.

Inside there were old photographs, a school medal, a few letters in blue ink, and a small notebook. The photographs were in black and white. In one of them my grandfather was about twenty, standing in front of a small house with two friends. They were all wearing simple summer clothes and smiling. The notebook was full of short notes about his work as a teacher: which lesson worked well, which student needed help, what he wanted to try next.

At first I felt strange as if I was reading something private. But my mother said it was good that I had found the box. She told me that my grandfather had always wanted his grandchildren to know about him. After dinner we sat at the kitchen table and looked at the photographs together. My mother explained each one. I learned more about my grandfather in two hours than in all my previous twelve years.

1. What were the speaker and parents doing?

A) Cooking lunch.

B) Tidying the attic.

C) Watching a film.

2. Whose box did the speaker find?

A) Their mother's.

B) Their grandfather's.

C) Their brother's.

3. How old was the speaker when the grandfather died?

A) Seven.

B) Twelve.

C) Twenty.

4. What was inside the box?

A) Money and gold.

B) Photographs, a medal, letters and a notebook.

C) Children's toys.

5. What was the grandfather doing in one photograph?

A) Standing with two friends in front of a small house.

B) Riding a horse.

C) Cooking dinner.

6. What was the grandfather's job?

A) A doctor.

B) A teacher.

C) An engineer.

7. How did the speaker feel at first?

A) Excited.

B) Strange as if like reading something private.

C) Bored.

8. What did the mother explain?

A) Each photograph.

B) Why the box was locked.

C) How to repair the medal.

LISTENING

A voice note about yesterday

Script:

Hi, it's me. Just sending you a quick voice note because typing this would take forever. So, you know I had that crazy day yesterday? It just kept going. Imagine: I get to the office, finally, after walking down nine floors and forgetting my phone, and there's a meeting starting in five minutes. My boss looks at me, does not say anything, just smiles. Apparently everyone has a story about that lift.

Then around three, a colleague — Marina, you do not know her — asks if I am walking home. She is also without her phone, can you believe it? Two of us, in 2026, without phones. We walked through the park, talked about everything: her divorce, my new flat, why we hate Tuesdays. By the time I got home I felt better than I had in weeks.

Anyway, that is it. Call me when you are free. And maybe try a day without your phone, seriously. I think you would like it.

1. Why is the speaker sending a voice note?

- A) Because typing would take too long.**
- B) Because the speaker cannot read.
- C) Because the keyboard is broken.

2. What was about to start when the speaker got to the office?

- A) Lunch.
- B) A meeting in five minutes.**
- C) A team trip.

3. How did the boss react?

- A) He shouted.
- B) He did not say anything and just smiled.**
- C) He sent the speaker home.

4. Who is Marina?

- A) The speaker's neighbour.
- B) A colleague the listener does not know.**
- C) The boss's daughter.

5. What did Marina and the speaker do together?

- A) Watched a film.
- B) Walked home through the park, talking about everything.**
- C) Worked late in the office.

6. What did they talk about?

A) Only work.

B) Marina's divorce, the speaker's new flat, and why they hate Tuesdays.

C) The weather.

7. How did the speaker feel by the time they got home?

A) Better than they had felt in weeks.

B) Exhausted and unhappy.

C) About the same as usual.

8. What does the speaker suggest at the end?

A) Buy a new phone.

B) Try a day without a phone.

C) Move to another city.

WRITING

Write 100-120 words about a recent day that started badly but ended well. Include: what went wrong, what surprised you, how the day ended. Use past simple, past continuous, and at least one of: then, after that, in the end.

SPEAKING

Record 90 seconds. Describe a day in the last month when something small went wrong (you forgot something, missed something, got lost). Say what happened, what you did, and how the day actually ended.

GRAMMAR (RANGE & ACCURACY)

1. Last weekend I ____ my parents tidy the attic.

A) helped въ“ B) help C) helping

2. While we ___ old boxes, I found a small wooden box.

A) were sorting ВЪ" B) sorted C) sort

3. The box ____ to my grandfather.

A) belong B) belonged B) belonged B) belonging

4. I found ___ small wooden box.

A) a B) an C) the

5. Inside there ___ old photographs and letters.

A) was B) were B) were C) are

6. It was ___ box, full of memories.

A) grandfather B) grandfathers C) grandfather's D) grandfathers'

7. I learned more in two hours ____ in all my previous twelve years.

A) then B) than въ" C) that

8. We ____ at the kitchen table to look at the photos.

A) sat B) sit C) sitting

9. We looked at the photographs ____ dinner.

A) after ВЪ“ B) in C) on

10. My mother said it was good that I ____ the box.

A) find B) found C) had found D) was

11. At first I felt strange. ____, my mother explained each photo.

A) Then въ“ B) Because C) But

12. Choose the correct question.

A) Where the box was? B) Where was the box? ВЪ“ C) Where the box did to be?